

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2b – Wrong number



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Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and learner resources to download

Overview

This resource, ***Someone on the phone – Wrong number***, is part of Unit 2 of *English in my home* which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

There are three units of ***English in my home***:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as well as E3 and L1.

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides a minimum of 11 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit is divided into three units. Each unit has four topics:

Unit 1: Someone at the door (includes films)

- Topic a: Electricity meter reading
- Topic b: Charity collection
- Topic c: Parcel delivery
- Topic d: The neighbour

Unit 2: Someone on the phone (includes films)

- Topic a: Cold call
- **Topic b: Wrong number (the focus of this set of resources)**
- Topic c: An emergency
- Topic d: Getting a plumber

Unit 3: Something in the post

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the four topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time. Units 1 and 2 can last longer if teachers choose to use the transcripts, for example by getting the learners to act out sections of the dialogues.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone: overview

The unit provides up to 4 hours of classroom time, and covers 4 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The topics of *Someone on the phone* are called *A cold call*, *Wrong number*, *An emergency*, and *Getting a plumber*. The first two topics can be used in any order but ideally *An emergency* should be taught before *Getting a plumber*.

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: Wrong number – teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 1 hour. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to deal with 'wrong number' phone calls

Objectives

All learners will:

- become familiar with and use some useful phrases for dealing with wrong numbers
- take part in a role play, dealing with a wrong number

Preparation

You will need:

- learner resources (pages 10 to 13): one per learner
- a computer with internet connection and data projector to play the film ***Wrong number***

Someone on the phone – Wrong number – Teacher's pack

Procedure

Lead-in: speaking task

Dictate the following questions and then write on the board for learners to check. Tell learners to discuss the questions in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

- *When was the last time someone phoned you?*
- *Who phoned you?*
- *Why did the person call you?*
- *Did they call you on your mobile or your landline?*

Write '.....number' on the board. Tell the learners they are going to learn about using English on the phone, and ask what words can go before the word *number*, for example *landline number*. Explain what this is; ask what digits landline numbers start with in the town you are in (the 'dialling code' – in London, this would be 020). Elicit suggestions for lots of collocations; be prepared to feed ideas if the learners are unsure.

Possible answers: *mobile number; work number; contact number; home number; old number; new number; wrong number*

Ensure that you deal with the last two, as these come up in the film.

First viewing of the video: gist understanding

Explain that the learners are going to watch a short film, in which a couple (Arjun and Sunita) get a phone call at home. Tell learners to watch the film and think about this question (which you could dictate).

Why did the caller telephone Arjun and Sunita?

Ask learners to discuss the question in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Ask learners if they ever get calls like this, and if so, what they said to the caller. Elicit responses.

Task 1: understanding the film (true or false)

Distribute the learner resources (pages 10 and 11) and tell learners to read Task 1.

Ask them to discuss the questions in pairs and write the answers if they remember them. Monitor to assess whether you need to play the film again and play it again if you think it is necessary. (If you ask them if they want to see it again, more confident learners may say 'no', but shy or weaker ones may not dare ask.) Elicit group feedback of the answers.

Differentiation – for stronger learners, you could give them the additional task of writing down Sanjay's new phone number (843 655 22)

Task 2: useful phone language

Tell the learners that Arjun and Sunita use lots of useful phrases when they are speaking on the phone. Ask them to complete Task 2. For this activity, you could check the answers of someone who finishes early and then get the rest of the group to check with that learner; i.e. he/she becomes the teacher.

Ask if the speakers are polite to each other (answer – yes); ask which sentences show the speakers being polite (suggested answers – b; d; e; i)

Task 3: who says what?

Set up Task 3 where learners decide who said which phrase in Task 2. Rather than telling them the answers, replay the film for them to identify who said what.

At this stage, you could conduct the feedback by writing the ten sentences on the board. Drill the pronunciation, intonation and sentence stress of the phrases. Rub out the phrases and tell students to turn over their handouts. Now murmur each of the phrases, using appropriate intonation and word stress and tell the students to write the phrase you are attempting to say. Students check their writing in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Task 4: remembering the phrases

Hand out one copy of the gapped transcript to each learner (pages 12-13). Ask them to complete the text with the phrases from Task 2 / Task 3.

Differentiation – stronger learners could try to do this from memory, without looking back at the phrases in Task 2 and 3.

Task 5: role-play

In pairs, get the learners to read and role-play the wrong number phone call with the gapped transcript (starting from where the husband says 'Hello?'). Then, the stronger of the pair could place their handout face down, and the learners do the dialogue again, with prompts from the partner if necessary.

Task 6: freer speaking practise

Write some people's names on small, separate pieces of paper. You could use your learners' names.

Write a list reasons for ringing on other small, separate pieces of paper.

e.g. *I am ringing to ask if you want to come for lunch, go swimming, come to my birthday party etc.*

Put learners in pairs and give each pair 2 of the pieces of paper: a name (different to their own names) and a reason. Tell them to think of a short conversation where one learner rings a wrong number and says:

'Hi, (name on the paper), I'm ringing to ask you if you want to (reason on the paper).....'

Then they should use the phrases from Task 2 to improvise a short conversation. They could write down their conversation first if they prefer and then try acting it out.

Extension: speaking activities

In this episode, Sanjay Patel had moved house, but (presumably) not told his friend about this. You could ask the learners if any of them have moved house. Then in small groups, get them to think of all the things people need to do when moving house, and write them in a list from the most important down to the least important. (Telling friends the new address / phone number; telling the bank, employer etc; arranging to pay the final energy and phone bills).

On the subject of dealing with people you do not know, you could use other resources from *English in my home*:

- **Unit 1b: Someone at the door: Charity collection** (includes video)

You can also refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities on how to deal with wrong numbers at: <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-wrong-number>

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: wrong number – learner resources



Sunita (left) and Arjun (right)

Task 1: understanding the film

Watch the film. Are the statements true or false?

- a. Sanjay Patel lived in the flat before Sunita and Arjun.
- b. Arjun knows the caller.
- c. Arjun has a new job.
- d. Sunita and Arjun have grandchildren.
- e. The caller thinks that he is speaking to Sanjay Patel.
- f. The caller is Sanjay Patel's friend.
- g. Arjun gives the caller Sanjay Patel's new phone number.
- h. Sunita wants to meet the caller.

Someone on the phone – Wrong number – Teacher's pack

Task 2: useful phone language

Complete the phrases from the conversation in the film. Use the words in the box.

job	family	number	help	me
speak	worry	wrong	speaking	trouble

- It's me.
- Sorry to _____ you.
- Who do you want to _____ to?
- Are your _____ well?
- Thanks for your _____.
- Who am I _____ to?
- I think you've got the _____ number.
- How's work? How's the _____?
- Don't _____. I'm happy I could help.
- Have you got his new _____ please?

Task 3: who says what?

Who says the sentences in Task 2? Write the sentence under the person who says it.

The caller	Arjun
<i>It's me.</i>	

Task 4: remembering the phrases

Look at the transcript and fill in the gaps with phrases from Task 2 and 3.

Task 5: practising a phone call

Work with a partner. Practise reading the transcript aloud.

Video transcript - Task 4

Husband Do you know someone called... Sanjay Patel?

Wife Sanjay Patel?... No. Why?

Husband Look: there's a letter for him. Sanjay Patel, Flat 30, Bewick Court, Stanton Road...

Wife That's our address. How strange.

Husband Oh! I remember! He lived here before us.

Wife Oh yes, yes! Sanjay Patel! We've got his new address and phone number. We can write his new address here on the envelope, and send it to him.

(The phone rings. The husband answers it.)

Husband Hello?

Caller Hi!

Husband Hello.

Caller (a) _____

Husband Right.

Wife Who is it?

Husband I don't know.

Caller So, how are you?

Husband I'm fine, thank you, fine... And... how are you?

Caller Oh well, you know me. The same as always.

Husband Oh.. yes.

Wife Who is it?

Husband I don't know!

Caller So, how's work? (b) _____

Husband Well, it's good. But I only started last week. How did you know?

Someone on the phone – Wrong number – Teacher's pack

- Caller** And the family? **(c)** _____
- Husband** Yes, we're all very well thank you.
- Caller** And the grandchildren?
- Husband** The... grandchildren? My grandchildren?
- Caller** Are they all at university now?
- Husband** I'm 28? years old. My son is 6. I don't have any grandchildren. **(d)** _____
- Caller** Oh. I'm sorry. **(e)** _____
- Husband** My name's Arjun. I moved into this flat last month.
- Caller** Ah.
- Husband** **(f)** _____
- Caller** Sanjay. My friend, Sanjay Patel.
- Husband** Oh, he doesn't live here any more. He moved house last month.
- Caller** Oh dear, **(g)** _____
- Husband** Yes, I have... here it is. Have you got a pen?
- Caller** Yes.
- Husband** 843 655 22
- Caller** That's great. I'll ring that number. **(h)** _____
- Husband** No problem.
- Caller** **(i)** _____
- Husband** **(j)** _____ Bye.
- Caller** Goodbye. *(They hang up.)*
- Wife** So? Who was it?
- Husband** Oh! I don't know. I didn't ask!

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: Wrong number – answers

First viewing: gist understanding

The caller wanted to speak to his friend, Sanjay Patel, who lived in the flat before. He didn't want to speak to Arjun and Sunita.

Task 1: understanding the film

- a. T
- b. F
- c. T
- d. F
- e. T
- f. T
- g. T
- h. F

Task 2: useful phone language

- b. trouble
- c. speak
- d. family
- e. help
- f. speaking
- g. wrong
- h. job
- i. worry
- j. number

Task 3: who says what?

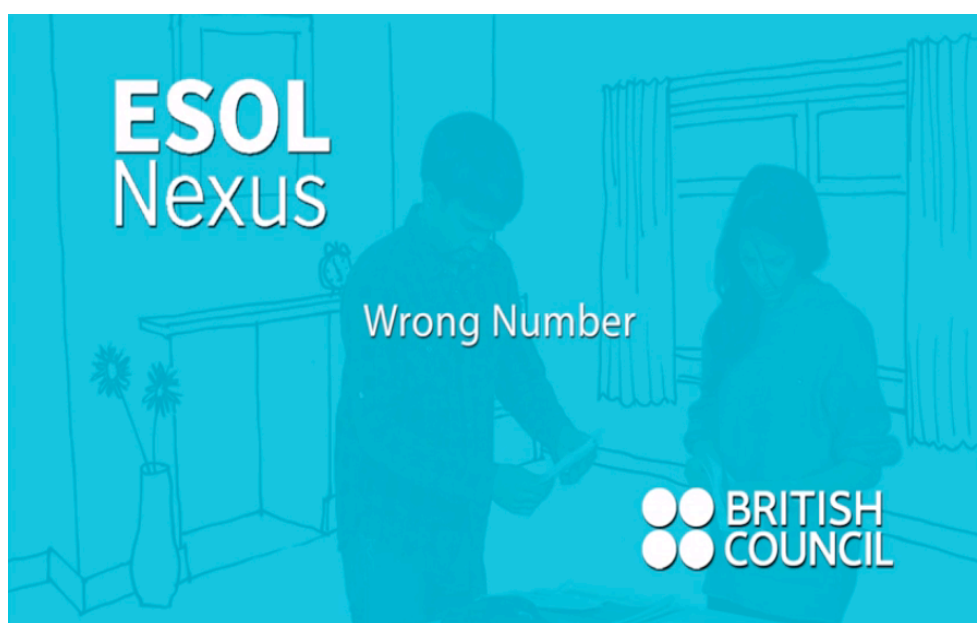
The caller a, b, d, e, f, h, j
Arjun c, g, i

Task 4: remembering the phrases

- a. It's me.
- b. How's the job?
- c. Are the family well?
- d. I think you've got the wrong number.
- e. Who am I speaking to?
- f. Who do you want to speak to?
- g. Have you got his new number please?
- h. Thanks for your help.
- i. Sorry to trouble you.
- j. Don't worry. I'm happy I could help.

Someone on the phone – 'Wrong number' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 2 'Someone on the phone – Wrong number' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.



Full video transcript

Husband Do you know someone called... Sanjay Patel?

Wife Sanjay Patel?... No. Why?

Husband Look: there's a letter for him. Sanjay Patel, Flat 30, Bewick Court, Stanton Road...

Wife That's our address. How strange.

Husband Oh! I remember! He lived here before us.

Wife Oh yes, yes! Sanjay Patel! We've got his new address and phone number. We can write his new address here on the envelope, and send it to him.

(The phone rings. The husband answers it.)

Husband Hello?

Caller Hi!

Husband Hello.

Caller **It's me!**

Husband Right.

Wife Who is it?

Husband I don't know.

Caller So, how are you?

Husband I'm fine, thank you, fine... And... how are you?

Caller Oh well, you know me. The same as always.

Husband Oh.. yes.

Wife Who is it?

Husband I don't know!

Caller So, how's? **How's the job?**

Husband Well, it's good. But I only started last week. How did you know?

Someone on the phone – Wrong number – Teacher's pack

- Caller** And the family? **Are your family well?**
- Husband** Yes, we're all very well thank you.
- Caller** And the grandchildren?
- Husband** The... grandchildren? My grandchildren?
- Caller** Are they all at university now?
- Husband** I'm 28? years old. My son is 6. I don't have any grandchildren.
I think you've got the wrong number.
- Caller** Oh. I'm sorry. **Who am I speaking to?**
- Husband** My name's Arjun. I moved into this flat last month.
- Caller** Ah.
- Husband** **Who do you want to speak to?**
- Caller** Sanjay. My friend, Sanjay Patel.
- Husband** Oh, he doesn't live here any more. He moved house last month.
- Caller** Oh dear, **have you got his new number, please?**
- Husband** Yes, I have... here it is. Have you got a pen?
- Caller** Yes.
- Husband** 843 655 22
- Caller** That's great. I'll ring that number. **Thanks for your help.**
- Husband** No problem.
- Caller** **And sorry to trouble you.**
- Husband** **Don't worry. I'm happy I could help. Bye.**
- Caller** Goodbye. *(They hang up.)*
- Wife** So? Who was it?
- Husband** Oh! I don't know. I didn't ask!